

GIOVANNY ALVAREZ

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of St. Thomas

Visiting Assistant Professor

Department of International Studies & Modern Languages

Houston, TX

Aug 2026 – Present

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Ph.D., Public Policy

Chapel Hill, NC

May 2026

Dissertation: "The Price of Elite Peace: A Dual-Arena Theory of Post-Conflict Violence"
International Studies Association Dissertation Completion Fellow
Saperstein Research Fellow, Wayne State University

M.A., Global Studies

Rotary Peace Fellow, The Rotary Foundation

May 2021

Universidad Nacional de Colombia

M.A., Political Studies

Outstanding Graduate Student Fellowship, Universidad Nacional de Colombia

Bogota, Colombia

May 2008

B.A., Political Science

June 2003

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Security, Conflict Resolution and Peacebuilding, Transitional Justice, International Development, Governance and Crime, Latin American Politics.

RESEARCH

Peer-Reviewed Publications

"The Economic Spoiler's Incentive: How Consent-Based Counternarcotics Policy Fueled Violence in Post-Conflict Colombia" *Studies in Conflict & Terrorism*. November, 2025.

"Building Partner Capacity: US Aid to Security Sector Actors" (with Patricia Sullivan and Nathan Marx). *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. Volume 69, no. 6 (2025): 1033–1058.

"Rediscovering Europe? The Aid Dilemmas During and After the Plan Colombia" (with Francisco Gutierrez Sanin). *Conflict, Security & Development*. Volume 8, no. 1 (2008): 71-107.

Under Review

“Pacifying Elites, Endangering Communities: A Dual-Arena Theory of Post-Conflict Violence.”

In Progress

“Dual Arenas of Violence: Elite Bargaining, Local Insecurity, and the Conditions for Comprehensive Peace in Ongoing Civil Wars”

ORIGINAL DATASETS

U.S. Aid to Security Sector Actors (USASSA) Dataset 2025

A comprehensive dataset tracking unclassified U.S. security assistance from 2000 to the present. Transforms detailed funding data into analytical aid typologies to evaluate the effects of security assistance on conflict and human rights.

Access: giovannyrvalvarez.github.io/USASSA/papers.html

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND HONORS

External

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, The International Studies Association	2025
Research Fellowship, Saperstein Symposium, Wayne State University	2025
Travel Grant ISA Conference 2026, The International Studies Association	2025
Rotary Peace Fellowship, The Rotary Foundation	2019–2021
Peace and Security Top-Level Global Seminar, SIDA	2009

Internal

The Philip and Jane Hammer Fund for Public Policy	2025
Experiential Learning Award	2025
The Graduate Student Transportation Grant	2025
Mellon Conference Travel Award, Institute for the Study of the Americas	2024
Stephens Family Fund for Graduate Student Excellence	2022
Professor Award for Outstanding Performance, Universidad Santo Tomas	2009
Outstanding Graduate Student Fellowship, Universidad Nacional de Colombia	2005–2007

PRESENTATIONS & WORKSHOPS

“Pacifying Elites, Endangering Communities: A Dual-Arena Theory of Post-Conflict Violence.”

- International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Conference. 2026.

“A Dual-Arena: The Divergent Effects of Transitional Justice on Post-Conflict Violence.”

- Peace Science Society (International), University of Central Florida. November 2025.
- International Studies Association & International Security Studies Section, Johns Hopkins University. October 2025.
- Triangle Institute for Security Studies-New Faces, Duke & UNC-Chapel Hill. September 2025.

"The effects of Transitional Justice in Post-conflict violence."

- Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science (SoWEPS-8), University of Kentucky. April 2025.

"Targeting Peace: Civilian Risk and the Unintended Consequences of Counternarcotics Reform in Colombia."

- International Studies Association, University of Pittsburgh. October 2024.
- Carolinas Conflict Consortium, UNC-Chapel Hill. April 2024.

"Post-Conflict and Murder in Colombia 2012-2020: Local Farmers on the Horns of a Dilemma."

- North Carolina Political Science Association, UNC-Wilmington. March 2023.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of St. Thomas

Visiting Assistant Professor

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|---|-----------|
| • INST 3352 - International Politics | Fall 2026 |
| • INST 3354 - International Political Economy | Fall 2026 |
| • INST 4351 - Latin American Economic Development | Fall 2026 |

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Teaching Fellow

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| • Global Policy Issues | Spring 2024, Spring 2025 |
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Teaching Assistant

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| • Data Literacy | Fall 2025, Spring 2026 |
| • Global Policy Issues | Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2024 |
| • Making Public Policy | Spring 2022 |

Instructor of Record (Undergraduate and Graduate Levels in Colombia)

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| • Humanitarian Action (U & G), Universidad Nacional de Colombia | 2011–2016 |
| • Security Policies (G), Escuela de Estudios Superiores de Policía | 2009–2011 |
| • Political Theory and Law (U), Universidad Santo Tomas | 2009–2010 |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| RTI International, <i>International Conflict and Transition Intern</i> | Summer 2020 |
| USAID Chemonics International, <i>Prevention Component Coordinator</i> | 2016–2019 |
| United Nations Development Program, <i>Specialist in Transitional Justice</i> | 2009–2016 |
| United Nations Development Program, <i>Consultant</i> | 2009 |
| Defensoria del Pueblo Colombia, <i>Research Assistant</i> | 2005–2008 |
| Presidencia de la Republica de Colombia, <i>Research Assistant</i> | 2005 |
| Defensoría del Pueblo Colombia, <i>Regional Coordinator</i> | 2004–2005 |
| Universidad de la Paz-MSD-CREDHOS, <i>Human Rights Researcher</i> | 2003–2004 |

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIP

Ad Hoc Peer Reviewer: *International Journal of Drug Policy* (Present).

Volunteer Mentor: American Political Science Association (APSA) Mentoring Program (Present).

University Service: Senator, Graduate and Professional Student Government, UNC-Chapel Hill (2020–2021).

Professional Memberships: American Political Science Association (APSA), International Studies Association (ISA), Peace Science Society (PSS), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Triangle Institute for Security Studies (TISS), Institute for the Study of the Americas (UNC).

SKILLS

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Fluent), French (Proficient)

Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference (Difference-in-Differences, Synthetic Control), Interrupted Time Series (ITS), Advanced Regression.

Software: Stata, R.